

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 26, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 46:16-24

16 Thus says the Lord God: "If the prince gives a gift of some of his inheritance to any of his sons, it shall belong to his sons; it is their possession by inheritance.

17 But if he gives a gift of some of his inheritance to one of his servants, it shall be his until the year of liberty, after which it shall return to the prince. But his inheritance shall belong to his sons; it shall become theirs.

18 Moreover the prince shall not take any of the people's inheritance by evicting them from their property; he shall provide an inheritance for his sons from his own property, so that none of My people may be scattered from his property."

19 Now he brought me through the entrance, which was at the side of the gate, into the holy chambers of the priests which face toward the north; and there a place was situated at their extreme western end.

20 And he said to me, "This is the place where the priests shall boil the trespass offering and the sin offering, and where they shall bake the grain offering, so that they do not bring them out into the outer court to sanctify the people."

21 Then he brought me out into the outer court and caused me to pass by the four corners of the court; and in fact, in every corner of the court there was another court.

22 In the four corners of the court were enclosed courts, forty cubits long and thirty wide; all four corners were the same size.

23 There was a row of building stones all around in them, all around the four of them; and cooking hearths were made under the rows of stones all around.

24 And he said to me, "These are the kitchens where the ministers of the temple shall boil the sacrifices of the people."

II. Key Summary

- A gift from the prince's inheritance to his sons stays theirs permanently, but a gift to one of his servants returns to the prince at the year of liberty (vv. 16-17).
 - God forbids the prince to take any of the people's inheritance or evict them from their property; if he wants to provide for his sons, it has to come out of his own holdings, so that none of God's people are scattered from what belongs to them (v. 18).
 - Ezekiel's guide shows him the place where the priests boil the trespass and sin offerings and bake the grain offering, then the four enclosed courts at the corners of the outer court where the temple ministers boil the people's sacrifices (vv. 19-24).
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III. Passage Analysis

Having power doesn't mean you get to take

"He shall not take of the people's inheritance, under pretence of having many children to provide for; he shall not find ways to make them forfeit their estates... but let him and his sons be content with their own. It is better for themselves to gain their affections by protecting their rights than to gain their estates by invading them." [1]

There was nothing wrong with the prince wanting to take care of his own sons. What was wrong was using "I have a need" as a reason to reach into what belonged to someone else. God's line is clear: if you're going to give, give out of your own share.

There were kitchens in the temple

"So the temple was a place for sacrificing, cooking and eating, as well as for prayer and so-called 'spiritual' activities. The Christian church has been the poorer when it has drawn a firm dividing line between spiritual life and social activities." [2]

The passage spends several verses on where the meat gets boiled and how big the kitchens are. That's a way of saying that in God's house, prayer and sacrifice aren't the only things that count — prepping food, lighting a fire, eating together all happen inside God's space too.

IV. Reflection Question

When you're the one holding something other people don't have — a bit more strength, more friends, more say in your group — what do you usually do with it?

God's instruction to the prince was specific: if you're going to give, give out of your own share, and never take the portion someone else has been given.

References

[1] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Commentary on Ezekiel 46,
https://www.blueletterbible.org/Comm/mhc/Eze/Eze_046.cfm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik's Commentary on Ezekiel 46 (quoting John B. Taylor),
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-46/>